

CONTAINMENT

Tabletop Simulator Handbook

Setup, table build, controls, and troubleshooting for the Authority vs. Ruin prototype.

This handbook covers getting the CONTAINMENT starter decks running in Tabletop Simulator: installing TTS, building the table (decks, playmat, counters, coins), the controls you'll actually use during a game, and fixes for the two custom-content errors you're most likely to hit. The full card-by-card decklists live separately in DECKLISTS.md.

1. Game Overview

CONTAINMENT is a two-deck head-to-head card game: **Authority** (control/midrange — secure, contain, and preserve) versus **Ruin** (aggressive risk/release — sacrifice, escalate, exploit). The decks share a single Breach Track that both players can push toward catastrophe.

Core Rules Reference

Rule	Current Standard
Deck size	60+ cards; these starter decks are exactly 60 cards.
Copy limit	Maximum 4 copies of a card with the same name, except Basic Facilities.
Starting state	20 Stability, 7-card opening hand, Breach 0, maximum hand size 7.
Resources	Normally deploy one Facility per turn. Facilities generate Energy; Research is a persistent secondary resource.
Signature systems	Shared Breach Track 0–10; Suppression; Containment/Release; Threat ratings; Research.
Competitive side deck	15 cards.

Breach Track Bands

Breach	Band	Note
0–2	Stable	—
3–4	Unstable	—
5–6	Danger	—
7–9	Critical	—
10	Catastrophic Breach	Each player loses 2 Stability, all Contained Anomalies are Released, each player Exhausts one Ready Facility, then Breach resets to 5.

Turn Order

Refresh → Breach → Draw → Main → Combat → Second Main → End.

2. Getting Started with Tabletop Simulator

Tabletop Simulator (TTS) is a paid sandbox game on Steam (one-time purchase, roughly \$20) available for Windows, Mac, and Linux. You need to own and install it before anything below will work — this handbook assumes you already have it running.

Save File Location

OS	Path
Windows	Documents\My Games\Tabletop Simulator\Saves
Mac	~/Library/Tabletop Simulator/Saves/
Linux	~/.local/share/Tabletop Simulator/Saves/

If you're loading a pre-built save file (e.g. CONTAINMENT_Mockup.json), drop it in that folder and use **Games** → **Load** from the TTS main menu.

Note: TTS loads card and board art from a URL, not from a local project folder. If you're using a pre-built save, its image fields need to point at real hosted images (imgur works, no account needed) or a local file:/// path for solo testing only.

3. Building the Table in TTS

If you're assembling the table yourself directly in TTS (rather than loading a pre-built save), here's the full sequence.

Step 1 — Import each deck

Objects → **Components** → **Custom** → **Deck** → set the face image, back image, and grid width/height to match your card sheet → Import. Repeat for the second deck and place it on the opposite side of the table.

Step 2 — Add the playmat

Objects → **Components** → **Custom** → **Board** → point it at your table image → Import. Scale it with the corner gizmo to fit the table, then right-click → Lock once it's positioned so it doesn't shift mid-game.

Step 3 — Add the counters

You need five counters, each via **Objects** → **Components** → **Counter**:

Counter	Starting value	Placement
Authority Stability	20	Near the Authority player's edge
Ruin Stability	20	Near the Ruin player's edge
Authority Research	0	Near the Authority player's edge
Ruin Research	0	Near the Ruin player's edge
Breach	0	On the Breach Track

Right-click each counter → Rename so it's labeled on hover, then click its + / – (or scroll wheel over it) to set the starting value.

Step 4 — Set up seats

Click an empty colored player tab at the edge of the screen to claim a seat. Only two are needed. Your seat color determines which hand zone is yours — cards dragged toward your edge hide automatically from the other player.

Step 5 — Deal opening hands

Right-click each deck → Shuffle, then right-click → Deal → set to 7. This deals a 7-card opening hand to each seated player, matching the rulebook.

Step 6 — Save

Ctrl+S once the table looks right — this becomes your base setup for future playtests.

4. Basic TTS Controls

Action	How
Move camera	Right-click drag = rotate/orbit, WASD/arrows = pan, scroll = zoom
Pick up / move an object	Left-click and drag
Flip a card or object	Select it and press R, or right-click → Flip
Draw a card from a deck	Left-click drag a card off the top of the deck
Deal a hand	Right-click deck → Deal → choose count and recipients
Adjust a counter	Right-click it → +/–, or hover and click the on-object buttons
Flip your view 180°	Press the period (.) key
Zoom in to read a card	Hold Alt and hover, or right-click → Zoom
Undo a mistake	Ctrl+Z
Save progress	Ctrl+S, or the save icon top-left

5. Custom Tokens / Coins

A physical token on a printed track is often the clearest way to show a bounded value like the Breach Track (0-10) at a glance — more readable across the table than a floating counter dial. Here's how to make one from your own art.

Menu path

Objects → Components → Custom → Custom Token

Image requirements

- Transparent background (PNG with a real alpha channel) — TTS cuts the token's shape out of the transparent area, so a circular icon on a transparent square becomes a round coin.
- Even pixel dimensions on both width and height (e.g. 512×512, not 501×499) — odd dimensions can trigger a Unity meshing bug.
- A small fully-transparent margin around the artwork, connected to the image border, so the cutout traces cleanly.
- Internal transparency (a hole inside the icon, like a donut) will not be cut out — only the outer edge transparency is used.

Import settings

Setting	What it does
Thickness	How tall the token sits (default ~0.2, a thin poker-chip feel).
Merge Distance	How tightly the cutout traces the transparency edge (default 15; raise it if the cutout looks jagged).
Stackable	Whether identical copies can form a stack.

6. Troubleshooting

“Failed to create Token from Image”

Check these in order — the first two cover the large majority of cases.

- 1 Odd pixel dimensions. Resize to even numbers on both sides (512×512, 500×500, etc).
- 2 Transparency doesn't reach the image border. Leave at least a 1px fully-transparent margin connected all the way around the artwork.
- 3 File extension doesn't match the real format. A JPG renamed .png has no alpha channel — re-export explicitly as PNG-24 with transparency.
- 4 Bad URL. Use the direct image link (ends in .png), not an imgur page URL, which returns HTML instead of image bytes.
- 5 Stale cache. If you fixed the image but TTS still fails, clear the cache (Options → clear cache) or fully relaunch, then re-import.

Inverted cutout (background kept, icon becomes a hole)

This means the alpha channel is backwards somewhere in the export pipeline — the area that should be transparent (the background) is opaque, and the icon itself is transparent.

How to check: open the file in an editor that renders transparency as a checkerboard (Photoshop, GIMP — not a plain image viewer, which typically shows transparent pixels as flat white and can hide the problem). If the checkerboard shows up inside the icon instead of around it, the alpha is inverted.

Fix, depending on how the transparency was made:

- Layer mask: the mask thumbnail is backwards. Select it and invert (Ctrl/Cmd+I), then flatten and re-export.
- Magic wand + delete: you likely selected and deleted the icon instead of the background. Undo, invert the selection (Select → Inverse), delete again.
- Automated background-remover tool: some invert the mask on low-contrast subjects. Re-run it, or manually invert just the alpha channel (not the RGB image) in the Channels panel.

After fixing, re-export as PNG-24 with alpha and re-upload under a new filename (or clear the TTS cache) before re-importing — TTS won't automatically refresh a previously-cached bad pull.

7. Appendix — Decklist Summary

High-level card counts only. Full card-by-card text, costs, and rules live in DECKLISTS.md alongside this handbook.

Deck	Category	Count
Authority	Personnel	20
Authority	Facilities	15
Authority	Equipment	7
Authority	Protocols	18
Authority	Total	60
Ruin	Personnel	16
Ruin	Anomalies	15
Ruin	Facilities	13
Ruin	Protocols	16
Ruin	Total	60

This is a design prototype — costs, wording, and quantities are subject to playtesting.